attempt to gouge you, and then if you use it to some purpose as I hope you will I shall say of you as the Turks do when they hear of any of their friends having stabbed a man and they approve of it "may his hand never ache."

You will no doubt wonder at my writing such a large straggling hand the reason of it is this. When Mr Bonham was here I had to copy a great many of his despatches. And one of the rules at the Foreign Office is that everything must be written in a large plain legible hand, which my handwriting most certainly was not. I am therefore endeavouring to get the habit of writing the sort of hand that is approved of. Even this hand would not be remarked but my former hand writing was such as would not pass. — I hope you will not have to pay postage on this, please let me know as if you have, I must write small again. It never occurred to me until this instant that in England a triple letter carried two hundred miles used to cost four or five shillings. I shall be very sorry if you have to pay this sum for this, but I hope that in America they have some thing like the Whigs penny postage system. And I believe my friends the Missionaries will send this to America for me free of expense at least they ought to do so, because our couriers carry their letters and even books and tracts, for nothing. Last winter when Mr Bonham was at Tehran and I was charged with the forwarding the Govt Messengers, I have packed up many a packet of theirs in Her Majestys despatch bags. —

I do not know whether you take any interest in the politics of these countries if you do not my letters must be uninteresting, but I hope you do, and I take great interest in the affairs of the U: S: altho I can not say that I am a great admirer of the people; perhaps I may be prejudiced against them. If you will engage to read every book you can find regarding Persia I will do the same with regard to the U: S: and I hope you have access to good maps. But perhaps you may have little time to look at books or maps either. I had none when I was at Kelsall's and if I had looked at a book or a map when I was at Cleggs I should have been mobbed by the whole family. I mention these things because two men to take interest in each others conversation or letters must be acquainted with some common subject of interest. Perhaps the most entertaining man I ever met, was a Hungarian doctor who was here for some years. He was a great linguist and spoke Turkish with great correctness ease and fluency. A Persian speaking of him the other day said "that was a man who if you were to live with him ten years would never tell you the same anecdote twice." He was a great miser and not a man of amiable disposition; but from his great information he was a most agreeable companion. — The Persians are frequently most agreeable companions full of fun and wit. The Hadji (Prime minister) is celebrated for abusing people and sometimes his abuse altho very gross is witty. The following

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